CRAIG HLONGWANI

Full-Stack Software Engineer

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Portfolio: portfolio-xi-bay-66.vercel.app | GitHub: github.com/craighlongwani

SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer who designs, builds and launches production web and AI-powered applications, from schema design and authentication through to billing and deployment. Experienced with React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js, Python/Django and Firebase, and with integrating LLM APIs into real products. Founder of two shipped platforms, with a solid grounding in networking and a growing focus on authentication security.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, C# and SQL (moderate)

Frontend: React, Next.js, React Query, Tailwind CSS, Vite, Capacitor, Expo, Figma

Backend: Node.js, NestJS, Express, Django, REST APIs, WebSockets, Auth.js

Databases: PostgreSQL, Firestore, MongoDB, Oracle

AI / LLM: Groq (Llama 3.3), Gemini, Together AI, OpenAI APIs, Google Vertex AI, prompt engineering, streaming responses

Cloud & DevOps: Vercel, Render, GCP, AWS, Cloudflare R2, Git, CI/CD

Networking & Security: Cisco Packet Tracer, firewalls, SSH, secure Wi-Fi, IP/MAC access control

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Full-Stack Engineer, CareerLaunch Africa 2025 – 2026 | Remote

- Built an AI-powered career platform with CV analysis, a live AI chat for drafting CVs, cover letter generation, a live mock-interview tool, job search and a built-in application system
- Integrated Groq (Llama 3.3) and Gemini APIs; migrated providers mid-project when free inference credits ran out, keeping the product running
- Implemented authentication, profile management and admin settings with Firebase Authentication and Firestore
- Designed Firestore-backed chat history with tiered retention for free and subscribed users
- Built real-time job alerts, email subscription workflows and push notifications; packaged for Android and iOS with Capacitor

Founder & Full-Stack Engineer, EngFind 2025 | Remote

- Built listings, image upload and gallery, and auction workflows on Firebase Authentication, Firestore and Storage
- Implemented role-based admin claims and admin management scripts
- Built a responsive React + Vite frontend with react-router-dom, contact and email handling (Formspree), and an Expo webview wrapper for web and mobile

PROJECTS

Glitchy Chats – Privacy-Focused Chat Application Python, Django, PostgreSQL, WebSockets

- Built real-time messaging with Django and WebSockets, using AJAX for dynamic updates, plus a news feed and user privacy controls over what is shared; deployed on Render and Vercel

CodeTube React, Firebase

- Built a video and project discovery app with user authentication, subscription management and payment integration

Organisational Network System Cisco Packet Tracer

- Designed a secured network with firewalls and access-controlled private areas, using IP and MAC address recognition to block unrecognised devices

EDUCATION & LEADERSHIP

BSc Computer Science, Eduvos 2025 – 2026

- **Class Leader:** coordinated scheduling and communication and made group decisions under pressure

INTERESTS

Authentication security and ethical hacking, AI product development, building in public